



REGULAR BOARD OF EDUCATION MEETING MINUTES
DU QUOIN COMMUNITY UNIT SCHOOL DISTRICT #300
CENTRAL OFFICE - 845 EAST JACKSON ST.
DU QUOIN, ILLINOIS 62832
MEETING HELD IN K-8 MEDIA CENTER
MONDAY, MARCH 16, 2026
6:00 P.M.

Rich Gossett - President
 Tracy Fenton - Vice President
 Tracy Taylor - Secretary
 Jason Furlow - Member
 Jim Kowzan - Member
 Breeonna Williams - Member
 Josh Williams – Member

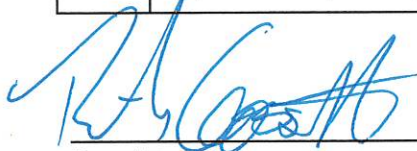
Administrators present: Diana Rea – Superintendent, Assistant Superintendent – Justin Engelmann, Amanda Milam – Elementary School Principal, Denise Woodsides – Middle School Principal, Eric Kirkpatrick – High School Principal, Zach Jones – Assistant High School Principal, Ryan Summers – Elementary Dean of Students, Jeremy Cornett – Middle School Dean of Students.

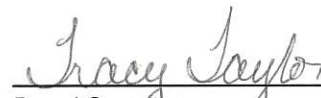
Others present: Denise Hirsch – Recording Secretary, Matthew Benson – Attorney for the Board, Mandie Davis – DEA Co-President, Pete Spitler – Du Quoin Weekly, Abby Porter – John A Logan College Manager of Dual Credit and Partnerships.

	Item	Info	Action
I.	Call to Order The meeting was called to order at 6:00 PM by President Rich Gossett.		
II.	Roll Call Present – Fenton, Furlow, Gossett, Kowzan, Taylor, B. Williams. Absent – J. Williams.		
III.	Reports A. Building principals – Ms. Milam, Mrs. Woodsides and Mr. Kirkpatrick shared with the Board Reasons We Are Proud. Each principal went over their attendance reports and athletics. B. Assistant Superintendent – Mr. Engelmann shared with the Board that there are no updates regarding the asphalt/press box projects. The grass mowing bids will be awarded later in the meeting. C. Superintendent - Mrs. Rea shared with the Board the teachers that got awarded mini grants through the Du Quoin Educational Foundation. The Red & Black District magazine will start interviews for the spring edition on March 20. The Full Service Community School grant funds through the end of the summer program and calendar reminders for the end of the school year and testing begins in April for the students. a. Abby Porter shared with the Board an update on the John A. Logan Promise Scholarship which will begin with the graduating class of 2030.		
IV.	Consent Agenda A. Approval of the minutes of the February 9, 2026 special meeting and February 17, 2026 regular meeting; B. Adoption of resolutions to abate property taxes relative to Series 2017A and 2017B Bonds; C. Approval of IHSA membership for Du Quoin High School for the 2026-2027 fiscal year. A motion was made by Kowzan, seconded by Fenton to approve the consent agenda as presented. Roll call vote: Aye – Fenton, Furlow, Gossett, Kowzan, Taylor and B. Williams; Nay – None. Motion carried.		
V.	Public Hearing D. DEA Representative – No comment. E. Public – No comment.		

VI.	Executive Session A motion was made by Furlow, seconded by Fenton to enter into executive session at 6:28 PM to discuss the appointment, employment, compensation, discipline, performance or dismissal of specific employees in accordance with 5 ILCS 120/2 (c) (1). To discuss security procedures, school building safety and security. 5 ILCS 120/2 (c) (5). To discuss student disciplinary cases 5 ILCS 120/2 (c) (9). To discuss minutes of meetings lawfully closed, whether for purposes of approval or semi-annual review 5 ILCS 120/2 (c) (21). Roll call vote: Aye – Fenton, Furlow, Gossett, Kowzan, Taylor and B. Williams; Nay – None. Motion carried. A motion was made by Kowzan, seconded by Fenton to return to regular session at 7:21 PM.		
VII.	Consideration of and Possible Action of the Executive Session A. Approval of executive session meeting minutes from February 9, 2026 special meeting and February 17, 2026 regular board meeting. A motion was made by Taylor, seconded by Kowzan to approve the minutes of the February 9, 2026 special meeting and February 17, 2026 regular meeting. Roll call vote: Aye – Fenton, Furlow, Gossett, Kowzan, Taylor and B. Williams; Nay – None. Motion carried. B. Consideration motion to accept retirement notice as received. a. Heather Bookstaver retirement amendment, effective end of the 2025-2026 school year. A motion was made by Furlow, seconded by Fenton, to accept the retirement amendment from Heather Bookstaver effective at the end of the 2025-2026 school year. Roll call vote: Aye – Fenton, Furlow, Gossett, Kowzan, Taylor and B. Williams; Nay – None. Motion carried. C. Consideration of resignation as received. b. High School Student Council Co-Sponsor - A motion was made by Fenton, seconded by Furlow to accept the resignation from Sarah McKinnies as High School Student Council Co-Sponsor. Roll call vote: Aye – Fenton, Furlow, Gossett, Kowzan, Taylor and B. Williams; Nay – None. Motion carried. D. Consider motion to approve recommendations for employment – a. Elementary School Teacher, 3rd Grade, effective 2026-2027 school year – A motion was made by Furlow, seconded by Kowzan to hire Sophie Miller as Elementary School 3rd Grade teacher effective for the 2026-2027 school year. Roll call vote: Aye – Fenton, Furlow, Gossett, Kowzan, Taylor and B. Williams; Nay – None. Motion carried. b. Elementary School Teacher, 4th Grade, effective 2026-2027 school year – A motion was made by Kowzan, seconded by Furlow to hire Kloeey Harsy as Elementary School 4th Grade Teacher effective for the 2026-2027 school year. Roll call vote: Aye – Fenton, Furlow, Gossett, Kowzan, Taylor and B. Williams; Nay – None. Motion carried. c. Middle School Science Teacher, effective 2026-2027 school year – A motion was made by Fenton, seconded by Furlow to hire Jennifer Harsy as Middle School Science Teacher effective for the 2026-2027 school year. Roll call vote: Aye – Fenton, Furlow, Gossett, Kowzan, Taylor and B. Williams; Nay – None. Motion carried. d. Middle School Math Teacher, effective 2026-2027 school year – A motion was made by Kowzan, seconded by Gossett to employ Alex Zimmerman as Middle School Math Teacher effective for the 2026-2027 school year. Roll call vote: Aye – Fenton, Furlow, Gossett, Kowzan, Taylor and B. Williams; Nay – None. Motion carried. e. High School custodian, effective immediately – A motion was made by Furlow, seconded by Fenton to hire Christopher Jeschke as High School custodian effective immediately. Roll call vote: Aye – Fenton, Furlow, Gossett, Kowzan, Taylor and B. Williams; Nay – None. Motion carried. f. Re-employment of licensed contractual probationary and contractual and tenured licensed faculty for the 2026-2027 school year. A motion was made by Furlow, seconded by Fenton the re-employment of licensed contractual probationary and contractual and tenured licensed faculty for the 2026-2027 school year. Roll call vote: Aye – Fenton, Furlow, Gossett, Kowzan, Taylor and B. Williams; Nay – None. Motion carried. g. Annual reduction-in-force notices for certain extra-curricular positions held by non-association members in accordance with the collective bargaining agreement between the Du Quoin Education Association and Board of Education. A motion was made by Furlow, seconded by Fenton the annual reduction-in-force notices for certain extra-curricular positions held by non-association members in accordance with the collective bargaining agreement between the Du Quoin Education Association and Board of Education – John Horn - Assistant Football Coach, Bailie James - Assistant Softball Coach, Adam Croxton – Girls Soccer Coach. Roll call vote: Aye – Fenton, Furlow, Gossett, Kowzan, Taylor and B. Williams; Nay – None. Motion carried.		
VIII.	Financial Items A. Approval of the payment of bills for February 2026. A motion was made by Fenton, seconded by Kowzan the approval of bills for February 2026.		

	Roll call vote: Aye – Fenton, Furlow, Gossett, Kowzan, Taylor and B. Williams; Nay – None. Motion carried. B. Approval of the February 2026 financial reports. A motion was made by Fenton, seconded by Kowzan the approval of the February 2026 financial reports. Roll call vote: Aye – Fenton, Furlow, Gossett, Kowzan, Taylor and B. Williams; Nay – None. Motion carried.		
IX.	New or Unfinished Business A. Lawn Service Contract. A motion was made by Furlow, seconded by Fenton to award the lawn service contract to Lawns and More for a 3-year contract. Roll call vote: Aye – Fenton, Furlow, Gossett, Kowzan, Taylor and B. Williams; Nay – None. Motion carried. B. Approval of school handbook language changes for 2026-2027. A motion was made by Fenton, seconded by Furlow the approval of school handbook language changes for 2026-2027. Roll call vote: Aye – Fenton, Furlow, Gossett, Kowzan, Taylor and B. Williams; Nay – None. Motion carried. C. Consideration of date for 8th Grade Promotion. A motion was made by Fenton, seconded by Furlow to set the date for 8th grade promotion to Tuesday, May 26th at 6 pm in Anders Gymnasium. Roll call vote: Aye – Fenton, Furlow, Gossett, Kowzan, Taylor and B. Williams; Nay – None. Motion carried. D. Authorization of amending the FY26 school district budget. A motion was made by Fenton, seconded by Furlow the authorization of amending the FY26 school district budget. Roll call vote: Aye – Fenton, Furlow, Gossett, Kowzan, Taylor and B. Williams; Nay – None. Motion carried. E. Approval of School Resource Officer Agreement for the 2026-2027 school year. A motion was made by Kowzan, seconded by Fenton the approval of School Resource Officer Agreement for the 2026-2027 school year with the City of Du Quoin. Roll call vote: Aye – Fenton, Furlow, Gossett, Kowzan, Taylor and B. Williams; Nay – None. Motion carried. F. Adoption of Du Quoin CUSD 300 Board Protocols and Communication Expectations. A motion was made by Kowzan, seconded by Fenton the adoption of Du Quoin CUSD 300 Board Protocols and Communication Expectations. Roll call vote: Aye – Fenton, Furlow, Gossett, Kowzan, Taylor and B. Williams; Nay – None. Motion carried.		
X.	Adjournment A motion was made by Kowzan, seconded by B. Williams to adjourn at 7:47 PM. Roll call vote: Aye – Fenton, Furlow, Gossett, Kowzan, Taylor and B. Williams; Nay – None. Motion carried.		

 4-21-26
 Board President Date

 4-21-26
 Board Secretary Date